

CONNECTING TECHNOLOGY TO EMOTIONS

Build campus capability in human-centred AI, responsible technology and experience innovation

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Human insight • Responsible AI • Interdisciplinary innovation



AUDIENCE

Students, teachers & designers



DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00



FORMAT

Design & prototype lab



CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Position the institution at the intersection of human-centred AI, responsible technology and interdisciplinary innovation.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students learn to design around trust, emotion, inclusion and ethics - capabilities central to AI, products and meaningful technology adoption.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academicians open interdisciplinary research directions, differentiated IP and funding opportunities in human-centred AI and responsible technology.

■ What we will explore

- Recognise emotional tensions as sources of novel technology problems.
- Use stories and empathy evidence to guide responsible solution design.
- Balance usefulness, privacy, trust and inclusion through inventive frameworks.

■ What participants gain

- **Find unmet needs:** reveal novel human-technology problems worth researching.
- **Deepen contribution:** move beyond feature iterations to meaningful experience innovation.
- **Create defensible ideas:** shape non-obvious concepts with patent potential.
- **Build support:** present an ethical, partner-ready case for collaboration and funding.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

New interdisciplinary projects, responsible-AI research directions and partner-ready technology concepts.

Design for trust, agency and meaningful adoption

Participants use empathy evidence, emotional tensions and responsible design lenses to find better problems and build more human technology.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	Technology is an emotional experience	Use trust, anxiety, agency and belonging as innovation signals.
10:15-11:15	Find unmet needs	Use empathy interviews, emotional vocabulary and bias-aware observation.
11:30-12:45	Map the experience	Build personas, emotion journeys, moments that matter and design principles.
13:45-15:00	Invent around tensions	Use TRIZ for privacy-personalisation, ease-control and speed-care.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorm and IP lens	Transform failure modes into differentiated solution concepts.
16:15-17:00	Prototype with care	Pitch value, patent potential, emotional signals and ethical safeguards.

■ Who should attend

- Engineering, design, management and psychology students
- Teachers and researchers in technology-enabled learning, HCI and AI
- Product, UX and innovation teams in academic incubators

■ Methods & tools

- Emotion-led problem discovery
- Empathy interviews and journey maps
- Human-centred and inclusive design
- Foundations of affective computing
- TRIZ, reverse brainstorming and IP lens
- Partner pitch, trust and responsible testing

■ Takeaway toolkit

- An emotion journey map grounded in empathy evidence
- Human-technology tensions translated into design principles
- Differentiated concepts generated through TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A low-fidelity prototype with trust, inclusion and ethics checks

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Workbook, empathy/IP/ethics canvases, prototype materials and participation certificate can be included.

Three pillars of innovation

An idea becomes strategically interesting when it is **unique**, **hard to do** and **value adding** at the same time. The programs build student capability across all three.

01 UNIQUENESS

Meaningfully different

Students learn to ask whether the problem, insight or solution is genuinely different from what already exists - not merely a new implementation of a familiar idea.

SKILLS BUILT

Problem discovery, reframing, prior-art awareness, assumption breaking, divergent thinking and TRIZ.

02 HARD TO DO

Technically defensible

Innovation needs technical or execution depth. Students learn to work with constraints, contradictions, evidence and experiments so the idea is more than a superficial concept. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Systems thinking, technical trade-offs, experimentation, prototyping, non-obviousness and execution discipline.

03 VALUE ADDING

Creates real value

A clever idea is not automatically valuable. Students learn to connect innovation to a real user, institution, industry or societal need and define the change it should create. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Stakeholder insight, outcome framing, evidence, adoption thinking, value articulation and storytelling.

■ Why all three have to come together

Unique + valuable, but easy to copy

Interesting, but difficult to defend or sustain.

Unique + hard, but low value

Technically impressive, but unlikely to matter outside the project.

Hard + valuable, but not unique

Useful engineering, but limited differentiation or innovation claim.

Unique + hard + value adding

A stronger foundation for defensible innovation and meaningful impact.

■ How I help students build the three muscles

DISCOVER

Find tensions, unmet needs and consequential problems.

CHALLENGE

Question assumptions and seek a genuinely different angle.

BUILD

Work through constraints, contradictions and technical depth.

VALIDATE

Test evidence, stakeholder value, utility and feasibility.

COMMUNICATE

Turn the work into a research, patent or industry story.

THE CORE HABIT

Do not ask only, "Can we build it?" Ask: "Is it different? Is it difficult enough to be defensible? Does it create enough value to matter?"

What the three pillars are designed to enable

The objective is not idea generation for its own sake. Students learn to convert differentiated, substantive and useful ideas into stronger research, invention and industry-facing evidence.

■ Outcome 01 - Impactful research

UNIQUENESS

A consequential question, clearer research gap and a contribution that is meaningfully different.

HARD TO DO

Technical depth, rigorous methods, experiments, difficult trade-offs and credible evidence.

VALUE ADDING

A problem that matters to a field, stakeholder, industry, society or future system.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem landscape • novelty map • research question • experiment plan • contribution statement • publication pathway.

■ Outcome 02 - Patents and defensible IP

UNIQUENESS

Prior-art awareness and a clearly differentiated mechanism, method or system element.

HARD TO DO

Non-obvious technical substance, constraints and implementation depth that make the idea defensible.

VALUE ADDING

Utility, adoption potential and a reason the invention should exist beyond novelty alone.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Invention canvas • prior-art search terms • novelty hypothesis • non-obviousness rationale • prototype or evidence plan.

■ Outcome 03 - Industry-ready innovators

UNIQUENESS

Spot opportunities others miss and frame a differentiated response rather than repeating obvious solutions.

HARD TO DO

Move from idea to execution: handle constraints, collaborate, experiment, learn and improve.

VALUE ADDING

Connect technical work to business, user and societal outcomes and explain why it matters.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem brief • prototype or concept • decision rationale • outcome story • pitch • 30/60-day action plan.

WHAT ACADEMIC LEADERS CAN REVIEW AFTER A COHORT

Problem portfolio • research directions • possible IP candidates • experiment plans • industry-facing pitches • participant capability evidence • recommended next steps.

The program builds capability and stronger pathways. Publication, patent and hiring outcomes are not guaranteed and depend on the quality of subsequent work, evidence, review and execution.